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ACHIEVERS

Dr. APJ ABDUL KALAM
(1931-2015)



Avul Pakir Jainulabdeen Abdul Kalam was born in a Muslim family in Rameswaram. He was the 11th President of India and who is fondly remembered as People's President.

He completed his schooling at Ramnad, graduation from St. Joseph's College, Trichy, and went on to study aerospace engineering at the Madras Institute of Technology (MIT) after he joined the Defence Research Development Organisation (DRDO).

Kalam's family had become poor at his early age; he sold newspapers to supplement his family income.

He was a recipient of several prestigious awards, including the **Bharat Ratna**, India's highest civilian honour in 1997.

Kalam has written many books. Among them, very famous books are *India 2020, Wings of Fire, Ignited Minds, The Luminous Sparks* and *Mission India*..

His outstanding work earned him the title of the **'Missile Man of India'.**

Mr.VISWANATHAN ANAND



Viswanathan Anand was born in Chennai in a middle class family. His mother was a big fan of chess and taught him to play the game when he was just five years old. She encouraged and motivated him a lot and this laid the foundation for his future career as a chess player.

Anand has won the world chess championships five times (2000, 2007, 2008, 2010 and 2012).

He won the World Junior Chess Championship at the age of 14.

He became India's first grandmaster in 1988.

He was the first recipient of the **Rajiv Gandhi Khel Ratna Award** in 1991-92, India's highest sporting honour.

He received the nation's second highest civilian award Padma Vibushan in 2007.

Ms. S. ILAVAZHAGI



S. Ilavazhagi came from a poor family at Vyasarpadi, Chennai. His father is a daily wage-earning auto-rickshaw driver.

She participated in the 2008 **World Carrom Championship** at Palais Des Festivals, Cannes, France, and bagged her maiden women's title.

She participated and won the Indian National Carrom Championship in the same year after beating the former World Champion Reshmi Kumari.

Mr. MARIYAPPAN THANGAVELU



Mariyappan was born at Salem in Tamil Nadu. His mother raised her children as a single mother, carrying bricks as a labourer until becoming a vegetable seller, earning about Rs.100 per day.

He suffered permanent disability in his right leg. When he was young despite this setback, he completed secondary schooling. He says, "I didn't see myself as different from able-bodied kids."

In 2016, At the Rio Paralympics, he won the **gold medal in the men's high jump** T-42 event, with a leap of 1.89 m.

From the above examples, you will clearly understand that people from diverse backgrounds facing adverse conditions were still able to achieve greater success in their lives.